

Bedside Table



An illustrated companion to the guided course

Illustrative straight-apron form from the original drawing. Use the drawing and teacher-confirmed variations for manufacture.

Name

Class / Teacher

Use the book with the course

Read the matching module as your teacher introduces it. Study the image and explanation, complete the paper tasks, then record your own project evidence. The website holds the full question sets, presentations, videos and digital folio. This book covers all 60 named theory sections and selects three formative checks from each module.

Module	Focus	Pages
01 / Weeks 1–2	Brief, plans, WHS and mark-out	3–6
02 / Weeks 3–4	Timber selection and preparation	7–10
03 / Weeks 5–6	Frame joints and controlled shaping	11–14
04 / Weeks 7–8	Dry fit, adhesives and squareness	15–18
05 / Weeks 9–10	Approved storage and hardware	19–22
06 / Weeks 11–12	Top fitting and timber movement	23–26
07 / Weeks 13–14	Surfaces, repairs and inspection	27–30
08 / Weeks 15–16	Finishing, chemicals and sustainability	31–34
09 / Weeks 17–18	Quality evidence and evaluation	35–38
10 / Weeks 19–20	Final quality, care and handover	39–42
Original drawing	One complete source sheet	43
Tools and folio	Recognition and your project records	44–50

The original plan is reproduced unchanged on page 43. Curved aprons and storage need teacher-confirmed variations; they are not drawn on that sheet. Current classroom instructions control approval, assessment and submission. The website's separately labelled 2026 formal task is not a new assessment notice.

Matching course: <https://stevenowell.github.io/bedside-table-guided-course/>

Understand the whole table

Turn the brief into checks

A bedside table must be useful, stable, accurate and comfortable to use. The top supports ordinary bedside items, while the legs and frame keep it steady. Success criteria turn those needs into checks: closed joints, consistent component alignment, a secure top, smooth edges and an even finish. An attractive photograph cannot establish all of these. Record what will be inspected and what evidence would support each judgement before making begins.

Read views together

A front view, side view and plan view describe the same object from different directions. Trace each written dimension to its extension lines, then identify the component, reference face and orientation. The original drawing on page 43 is titled Occasional Table. It shows straight aprons; the website also discusses a curved apron and optional storage. Those features need a teacher-confirmed drawing or variation. Never measure a resized picture to obtain a cutting size.



Figure 1. Generic joint close-up: locate the mortise, tenon cheek and shoulder. The original drawing controls this project's joint dimensions.

Trace the load path

The top transfers load through the rails and apron into the four legs. Mortise-and-tenon connections help the frame resist twisting and racking. A thicker top cannot repair a loose rail-to-leg joint. At a shaped apron, both the joint area and the remaining timber must stay sound. Inspect connections as well as individual parts: a snug cheek and a fully closed shoulder contribute different evidence about how the frame fits.

Name two success criteria and state a different observation you could use to check each one.

Make reliable starting points

Control the task before starting

A hazard is something that can cause harm; risk concerns the likelihood and seriousness of that harm. Identify the source of harm in the planned task and follow the teacher's current machine SOP. Work holding, guards and extraction control exposure; PPE supports those controls. Secure loose hair and clothing, keep the workspace clear and stop if timber moves, binds or requires unexpected force. A recognition picture does not authorise a machine setup or operation.

Compare choices against the brief

A useful design sketch tests a choice. Compare function, strength, appearance, manufacture, time and material use, then explain the trade-off. A deeper apron curve may look distinctive but remove useful timber, create short grain or add difficult cutting. Fixed structural requirements still come from the drawing. Mark proposed changes clearly and obtain the teacher's decision before making. Storage is conditional: do not add a drawer because it appears in a website illustration.



Figure 2. The square's stock bears against a reference surface. Its blade transfers that reference across the adjacent face.

Keep a common datum

A datum is the reliable face, edge or point from which related marks are measured. Establish face side, face edge and a squared reference end. Keep the square against those surfaces, make fine marks and identify waste. Label and compare matching legs before marking joint faces and tapers. Measure each position from the common datum rather than copying one component onto the next. Read a rule directly above its graduation: an angled view can shift its apparent position, causing parallax error.

A marked set has four matching lengths but one reversed taper. Explain which check was missed.

Check, explain, apply

Choose one answer for each check. Use the readings to explain the practical decision below.

1. The plan is displayed smaller on your screen than it was when it was drawn. Which information should control the table dimensions?

- ☐ A Measurements taken from the picture with a ruler
- ☐ B The written dimensions and notes on the drawing
- ☐ C An estimate based on the completed table image
- ☐ D The measurements used by the student beside you

2. A broad curved front apron looks attractive but takes longer to machine and may create weak short grain. What is the strongest design decision?

- ☐ A Choose it only because it looks best
- ☐ B Reject appearance as irrelevant
- ☐ C Compare appearance, strength, function, time and manufacturability before deciding
- ☐ D Copy another student's design

3. Which action best prevents parallax error when reading a steel rule?

- ☐ A View the graduation from the side
- ☐ B Place your eye directly above the graduation being read
- ☐ C Use the thickest pencil available
- ☐ D Measure from a different end each time

Explain a mark-out routine that would prevent a mortise being placed on the wrong face of a leg. Include your reference surfaces, labels and the check before cutting.

Turn an observation into a decision

Worked example / hypothetical

A rail has the correct length, but its shoulder marks were squared from a rough edge. The length check cannot prove the shoulder is square. The maker checks the prepared datum, re-establishes the shoulder lines from that reference and compares the marks with the drawing before cutting.



Figure 3. A tenon saw, square and pencil have different roles: remove waste, transfer an angle and record a mark. Tool choice follows the required result.

Sketch one leg blank. Label its face side, face edge, datum end, component position and the waste side of a proposed taper.

Explain one check that must happen before the first cut.

Plan the timber before cutting

Turn views into component information

A working drawing communicates size, position and shape. A component may look similar to another but have a different length, joint or orientation. Read the front, side and plan views with their notes, then label each part by its place in the frame. Check which surfaces stay visible and where tapers begin. Written dimensions control the work; a correctly read figure applied to the wrong face is still an error.

A cutting list connects plan and stock

Record component name, quantity, material, finished requirements and any pairing or shaping notes. Rough stock may need an allowance for dressing, kerfs or damaged ends, but the teacher confirms that allowance. Check the complete list against the assembled design, including legs, side rails, front and rear members and top pieces. Add storage parts only for the approved version. Keep stock requirements separate from finished dimensions so the two are not accidentally substituted.



Figure 4. Illustrative timber defects: compare the knot, end split and change in grain before choosing a component position.

Inspect timber in its intended position

Look along the board for bow and twist, across it for cup, and at ends and faces for splits, checks, knots or embedded material. The location matters: a defect at a narrow taper or joint can be more serious than the same feature in removable waste. Compare visible colour and grain without letting appearance override sound timber. Mark doubtful areas and discuss an alternative position or piece before allocating components.

Why is “one attractive face” insufficient evidence that a board suits a tapered leg?

Prepare, match and verify

FEWTEL establishes useful references

FEWTEL means face, edge, width, thickness, end and length. Preparing one flat face and an adjacent straight square edge establishes references for later work. Width and thickness are then checked from those reliable surfaces; the end and final length complete the component preparation. The teacher selects the authorised machines or hand tools. Inspect the stock first and check each result with an appropriate straightedge, square or rule rather than assuming one pass has made it accurate.

Keep visible components as sets

Arrange the four legs and paired rails together before their labels or orientation can be lost. Compare grain direction, colour and visible faces, and consider how a narrow taper will affect grain continuity. Lay out top boards as a group before joining. Attractive figure has value only when the component remains sound. Record a significant timber-placement decision in the folio, including the defect or appearance issue and why your chosen position is suitable.

Explain why a marking gauge cannot compensate for an unreliable reference edge.



Figure 5. A marking gauge transfers a consistent offset from a reference edge. Its setting and reference still need checking against the required feature.

Use a hold point before joinery

A hold point is a deliberate pause before work becomes harder to correct. Check the real blanks for straightness, squareness, size, labels, orientation and defects before marking joints. A component that moves after preparation may need reassessment; do not machine its joints simply because the cutting list is complete. Compare matching parts directly and retain datum marks until they have served their purpose. Confirm that any correction can leave the required finished size.

Check, explain, apply

Choose one answer for each check. Use the readings to explain the practical decision below.

1. Why are rough-cut timber blanks often prepared slightly oversize before final dressing?

- ☐ A To make the table permanently heavier
- ☐ B To allow saw marks, damaged ends and distortion to be removed while reaching the finished size
- ☐ C Because written dimensions are only approximate
- ☐ D So sanding can replace accurate machining

2. Why does the FEWTEL sequence begin by establishing a flat face and a square edge?

- ☐ A Because the remaining surfaces need reliable references
- ☐ B Because length is never important
- ☐ C Because a thicknesser automatically removes all twist
- ☐ D Because the sequence is alphabetical

3. What is the strongest reason for labelling prepared bedside-table components?

- ☐ A It allows the labels to control final dimensions
- ☐ B It preserves component identity, orientation, datum faces and matched relationships through later processes
- ☐ C It makes dry fitting unnecessary
- ☐ D It allows left and right parts to be swapped at random

A prepared leg twists slightly before joinery is marked. Explain the next decision and why it must happen now.

Read stock notes without guessing

Worked example / the original drawing

The plan note specifies three top boards, each 150 × 25 × 500. Three widths of 150 total 450, while the plan view shows a finished top 500 × 400. These are different pieces of information: the stock note is not permission to make the finished top 450 wide. Confirm the preparation and joining allowance with the teacher.



Figure 6. Loose biscuits and dowels are different joining aids. The original top note specifies biscuit joining; do not substitute another system from a picture.

Component / quantity	Plan or stock note	Teacher-confirmed preparation
Top / three boards		
Legs / check full set		
Rails / identify each position		

Record two other details that must be settled before a cutting list becomes a cutting instruction.

Connect the frame accurately



Figure 7. Illustrative mortiser at rest: locate the feed lever, cutter assembly, fence and work-holding clamp. This is an identification view, not an operating setup.

The frame works as a connected system

Rails and aprons tie the four legs together and support the top. Their joints help resist side movement and racking, so correct length alone is insufficient. Keep front, rear and side components labelled and compare joint marks from common datums. A reversed taper or misplaced shoulder can change the assembled frame. Preserve the timber around joints when shaping an approved profile. Grain direction and a sound remaining section matter wherever a member narrows.

Check cheeks and shoulders

The mortise receives the projecting tenon. Broad cheeks provide fitting and gluing surfaces; square shoulders close against the leg and locate the rail. The joint should seat with controlled hand pressure during a dry fit. A binding cheek, open shoulder or loose fit needs diagnosis before adhesive. Hammering can split or bruise parts. The original note gives mortises and tenons as $10 \times 40 \times 15$; confirm each feature and orientation from the detail view.

Make a useful mortiser trial

A hollow-chisel mortiser combines an inner rotating bit with a square hollow chisel. Accuracy comes from references, holding and setup, not extra force on the lever. Under the teacher's SOP, use a similar prepared offcut to check the proposed result. Keep material and target mortise comparable when evaluating an approved alternative. Record both the timber's response and the process result: accuracy, splitting, tear-out, control and waste. Never trial unapproved equipment or settings.

Name one material observation and one process observation worth recording from a mortiser test piece.

Shape while protecting the references

Compare all four tapers first

Mark each taper from the prepared references shown by the drawing. Arrange the labelled legs as they belong in the table and compare the start, finish, waste side and joint faces. Cutting the correct angle on the wrong face still creates an incorrect component. Preserve useful datums until the dependent joint work has been checked. The teacher directs the safe shaping sequence and work support; do not copy a machine setting from an illustration.

A curve needs a sound remaining section

The website's broad curved front apron is a design variation from the straight apron on the original sheet. Use a teacher-confirmed profile or template if that variation is approved. A fair curve changes gradually without flats or bumps. It must preserve the shoulder area and useful timber between the joints. A deeper decorative cut can introduce weak short grain or unnecessary difficulty. Check the complete profile before removing its waste.



Figure 8. Illustrative bandsaw at rest, with no workpiece. Identify the enclosed wheel housings, table and blade guide; the teacher sets the operating guard and support for each task.

Refine the result with control

A bandsaw can remove most of the waste from an authorised taper or curve; follow the current SOP, guard and support requirements. Leave the final reference line for controlled refinement. Select a plane, chisel, rasp, file or abrasive for the surface and grain direction being worked. Remove small amounts and compare with the reference often. Stop if the timber moves, binds or needs unexpected force. A smooth surface that has lost its required shape is still inaccurate.

Why should the final reference line remain visible after rough shaping?

Check, explain, apply

Choose one answer for each check. Use the readings to explain the practical decision below.

1. Which plan gives the fairest evidence about both material suitability and the effectiveness of a mortising tool, equipment and process?

- ☐ A Use matching offcuts of the same prepared timber and the same target mortise, follow teacher-approved options or criteria, and record each result
- ☐ B Use different timbers and mortise sizes, then choose whichever trial finishes first
- ☐ C Change unapproved machine settings directly on a project component until the cut looks acceptable
- ☐ D Judge only the appearance of the final hole and ignore control, accuracy and waste

2. Why should the finished line remain visible after the bandsaw cut?

- ☐ A So the component can be refined accurately to final size
- ☐ B Because the line strengthens the timber
- ☐ C So the joint position can be guessed from the curve
- ☐ D Because sanding can add material back later

3. What does full shoulder contact in a mortise-and-tenon joint mainly help to provide?

- ☐ A Location, alignment and a neat closed joint
- ☐ B A deliberately loose connection
- ☐ C A larger bandsaw kerf
- ☐ D Protection from chemical vapours

A tenon feels tight but its shoulder stays open. Explain what should be inspected before any correction.

Compare a trial fairly

Worked example / hypothetical evidence

Two mortising trials produce different amounts of tear-out, but one used a sound straight-grained offcut and the other used a split end. The material changed, so the result cannot be attributed confidently to the tool. A fairer comparison uses matching prepared offcuts and the same required mortise, with only teacher-authorised methods.

Keep comparable	Method A / criteria	Approved method B / criteria
Prepared timber and target		
Material response		
Accuracy, control and waste		

Plan the comparison. If only one method is authorised, state the success criteria you would check instead.

State the hold point before the project component is machined.

Rehearse before the glue clock starts

Dry fit to find the cause

Dry fitting assembles the frame without adhesive while corrections remain possible. Return labelled components to their intended locations and close each joint without forcing it. Look for open shoulders, proud faces, reversed tapers, uneven rails and twist. Check the frame as a whole as well as each connection. Record the fault and likely cause, then correct the cause with teacher direction. Glue and clamp pressure cannot turn a poorly fitting frame into an accurate one.

Sequence the assembly for access

Rehearse which joints close first and whether subassemblies are needed. Place the right clamps, protective pads, measuring tools and clean-up materials within reach. Check that an early clamp will not obstruct a later joint or the diagonal measurements. A complex one-step assembly may exceed the adhesive's open time. Plan a sequence that lets the joints close while retaining access to inspect shoulders, orientation and squareness. The rehearsal should settle those decisions before adhesive is opened.



Figure 9. Generic dry-run still life: a loose frame, clamps and pads ready for planning. It does not show the Bedside Table's final clamp arrangement.

Prepare the bond

The adhesive must suit the actual timber, joint, service conditions and workshop process. Follow its instructions for preparation, application, working time and curing; the book does not nominate a brand or time. Joint surfaces need to be clean and sound. An even application matters, but flooding the joint is not a repair for poor fit. Keep approved clean-up materials ready so residue can be managed without spreading glue into visible grain or disturbing the assembly.

Give one reason to rehearse the clamp positions as well as the assembly order.

Check square, flat and fully closed

Clamp through the joints

Position clamps so pressure closes the intended joints without pulling the frame out of alignment. Pads or cauls protect visible timber from local dents. Use controlled pressure and watch shoulder closure, rail alignment and the complete frame as adjustments are made. More force can distort parts or bruise timber. The clamp arrangement must leave safe access to the required checks. The teacher confirms a suitable support and clamping method for the actual assembly.

Diagonals are one part of the check

Measure diagonals between the same corresponding reference points. For a correctly formed rectangular frame, comparing those readings helps reveal racking. Equal readings alone do not prove every corner, joint or surface is correct: inspect shoulder closure, alignment and twist as well. Recheck after an adjustment because improving one measurement can open a joint elsewhere. Diagnose the cause before shifting pressure, then record the actual readings and observations rather than writing only “square”.



Figure 10. A clamp applies force through its faces. Protective pads and the direction of that force matter as much as the clamp's capacity.

Protect the curing assembly

Curing is part of assembly. Use the approved method to remove squeeze-out at the appropriate stage, avoiding a residue that blocks later finish penetration. Support the frame so it is not twisted or stressed while the bond develops. Follow the product and teacher instructions for clamp removal and further handling; an apparently closed joint is not proof of full strength. Record the hold point and next permitted stage before moving or loading the work.

Why should a “diagonals match” note include at least one other observation?

Check, explain, apply

Choose one answer for each check. Use the readings to explain the practical decision below.

1. Why should a complete dry fit occur before adhesive is opened?

- ☐ A To confirm fit, sequence, clamp access and measurements while correction is still easy
- ☐ B To make the adhesive dry faster
- ☐ C To remove the need for labels
- ☐ D To avoid checking squareness

2. Why are clamp pads used on finished timber surfaces?

- ☐ A To spread pressure and prevent jaw marks or bruising
- ☐ B To make the joint permanently flexible
- ☐ C To increase the hole diameter
- ☐ D To replace adhesive

3. After the frame has been clamped, what should be checked before it is left to cure?

- ☐ A Only the colour of the clamps
- ☐ B Joint closure, frame diagonals, flush references, clamp stability and squeeze-out management
- ☐ C Whether another student has finished
- ☐ D Whether the table can be used immediately

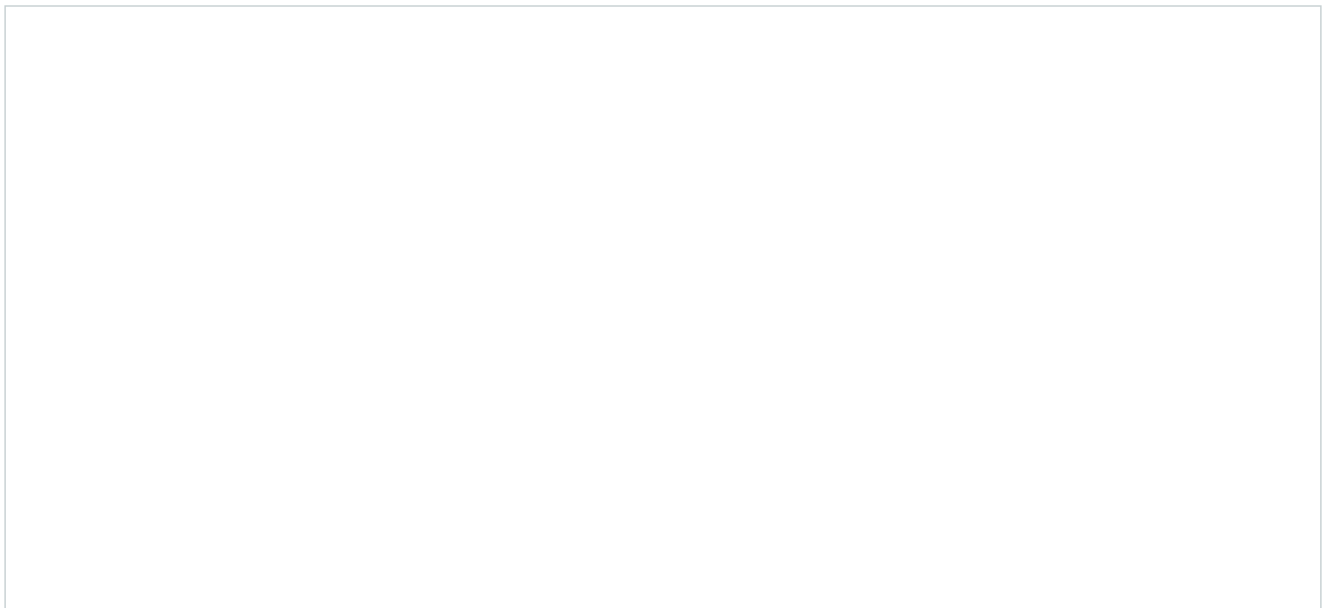
A dry-fitted frame has equal diagonals and closed shoulders, but rocks on a checked flat support. Explain why it still needs investigation before glue-up.

Read the assembly evidence

Worked example / hypothetical

A frame is measured between the same corner references. The diagonals are 486 mm and 490 mm: a difference of 4 mm. The maker records the difference, checks labels and shoulder closure and discusses the cause before adjusting. These are practice numbers, not Bedside Table dimensions or a permitted tolerance.

Draw a simple rectangular frame seen from above. Mark the four corner references and both diagonal measurement paths.



Another practice frame reads 508 mm and 501 mm. After adjustment both diagonals read 501 mm, but one shoulder opens. Calculate the original difference and explain whether the frame is ready for adhesive.

What would a useful follow-up record show after an approved correction?

Fit only the approved storage

Check whether the feature applies

The supplied original sheet does not show a drawer or shelf. This website module teaches how approved storage could be fitted; it does not add that feature to the drawing. Use a teacher-confirmed design before making storage or purchasing hardware. If your version has none, record “not applicable” with the plan reference in the folio, then apply the same principles of accurate references, dry fitting and secure support to the components your design actually requires.

Read the actual opening

Clearance is the space that allows a moving or removable part to fit and operate. A reveal is the visible gap around a front or face. Check width, height, diagonals and straightness at several positions in the actual opening. One measurement at the front cannot establish the fit through the whole travel. Allowances and gaps come from the approved design and hardware instructions; do not guess a universal figure or copy another student’s drawer.

What should the storage folio record contain when your approved version has no storage feature?

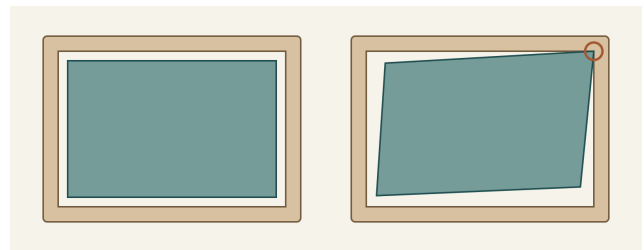


Figure 11. Conceptual fit study: compare an even reveal with one corner closing. The diagram explains the observation and supplies no construction clearance.

Keep the component square

An approved drawer requires matching, labelled parts, closed joints and a correctly supported base. Check the box’s diagonals and test progressively in its intended opening before final fixing. For a fixed shelf, check level, support and the specified fixing arrangement instead. Grain direction, surface preparation and later finish can affect fit. Never force a component into position: identify whether the fault belongs to the opening, the component or its hardware before removing timber.

Adjust the cause of a poor fit

Align the visible face first

A drawer front, where approved, is judged against the surrounding table. Support it in the intended position and check its relationship to the top, legs and apron from normal viewing angles. Compare the reveals and visible grain before transferring fixing positions. Temporary spacers or another teacher-approved method can hold the intended location. A well-made box behind an unevenly positioned front still gives an unsatisfactory result. Record the reference used so the adjustment can be explained.

Prepare fixing positions carefully

Use reliable references to mark matching hardware positions. The approved fixing, material and hardware instructions determine the pilot hole and screw requirement. Secure the component and confirm depth and clearance before drilling so a screw cannot break through a visible surface. Fit one part at a time and test. Over-tightening can strip a hole, distort a component or pull hardware out of line. A powered driver does not replace controlled alignment and checking.



Figure 12. Illustrative drill-driver at rest. The approved bit, work holding, depth and driving method must match the task and teacher instruction.

Observe the full movement

Observe where movement becomes difficult and what changes at that point. A single local rub may have a different cause from resistance through the full travel. Check for proud fixings, a misaligned runner, uneven clearance or a distorted opening before selecting a correction. Make one controlled, approved adjustment and retest the complete movement. For a fixed component, inspect secure support, level and alignment instead. A successful first movement does not prove consistent function.

A drawer rubs at one rear corner. Why would planing every edge be a poor first response?

Check, explain, apply

Choose one answer for each check. Use the readings to explain the practical decision below.

1. What controls whether the bedside table includes a drawer, shelf or other storage component?

- ☐ A Whichever option looks easiest on the day
- ☐ B The approved plan and teacher-approved variation
- ☐ C A generic furniture photograph
- ☐ D The hardware left over from another project

2. What is the strongest method for aligning a visible drawer front or approved storage face?

- ☐ A Reference it to the actual opening and approved reveals, support it in position, then mark fixing locations
- ☐ B Tighten one screw fully and hope the remaining gaps match
- ☐ C Align it only to the workshop floor
- ☐ D Sand the frame until the front happens to fit

3. How can the approved finish system affect storage-component fit?

- ☐ A Coating build can reduce a small clearance, so preparation and test fitting must follow the approved sequence
- ☐ B Finish always creates more clearance
- ☐ C Finish makes squareness irrelevant
- ☐ D The component should be soaked to make it fit

Explain how you would distinguish a problem in an opening from a problem in the moving component or hardware.

Investigate a fit without guessing

Worked example / hypothetical

An approved drawer moves freely until the final part of its travel, where one rear corner rubs. The maker marks the contact, checks the opening at the rear and inspects the corresponding fixing. The observation narrows the investigation; it does not prove which part should be cut.

Observation	Possible cause	A check before correction
Resistance at one point		
Resistance through full travel		
Front gap uneven		

Choose the full-travel or uneven-front-gap row. Explain how its result would guide an approved adjustment and the final retest.

If your table has no drawer, name a fitting check that still applies to its top or frame.

Read • notice • apply

Fit securely, allow movement

Aligning the thick top accurately

Positioning begins with a stable frame and the approved drawing. Compare the top overhang at the front, back and both sides from consistent references; do not centre it by eye from one corner. Check that the underside contacts the frame evenly before preparing any fixing. A chip, dried adhesive or proud joint can hold one corner high. Correct the verified cause before tightening, then recheck the position as work progresses. Screws must secure an accurate fit, rather than pull a fitting fault flat.



Figure 13. Illustrative timber block reused from the Clock workbook. The end face and long fibres help identify directions; the image supplies no species or movement measurement.

Why solid timber moves across the grain

Solid timber absorbs and releases moisture as surrounding conditions change. Its greatest dimensional movement is across the grain; movement along the long fibres is much smaller. The top and supporting rails may have different grain directions, so their movement must be considered together. Rigid restraint can cause splitting, cupping, pulled fixings or stress in the frame. An approved movement allowance keeps the top securely located while accommodating this change. It does not mean leaving ordinary screws partly loose or accepting an unstable top.

Using the approved top-fixing method

Confirm the exact top-fixing detail with the plan and teacher before marking. The course discusses movement-compatible fixings, but an example does not authorise a substitute on this project. Dry position the top, check contact and grain direction, then transfer locations from reliable references while preventing movement. Prepare only the specified pilot holes or slots with the directed support and depth control. Tighten progressively, checking seating and alignment. Stop when the top is secure and the intended movement remains available, without crushing the timber.

Explain how a solid top can remain secure while allowing movement. Name the direction of greatest movement and the authority for the fixing detail.

Read • notice • apply

Diagnose before tightening

Final hardware checks

Inspect only hardware required by the approved design. Check each position, the seating of each fixing and the surrounding timber for splitting, crushed fibres or damage to the screw head. No metal edge should stand proud or catch a hand or object. Test movement gently only where a component is designed to move. A loose fitting may need controlled tightening, while a misaligned fitting needs diagnosis. Increasing force can strip a hole or distort hardware without correcting its position or function.

Diagnosing a top that rocks, cups or sits unevenly

Treat rocking as a symptom rather than an instruction to sand. Establish a known flat reference, then inspect the frame and top separately. Check for frame twist, uneven bearing surfaces, debris, proud joints and displaced hardware. Use the directed straightedge and raking-light checks to locate distortion in the top. Mark the actual contact points before deciding on a correction. Seek teacher advice before planing a bearing surface, altering a joint or forcing a cupped top down; these actions can change approved geometry.

One corner is high and a fixing feels loose. Name two checks you would make before adding force, and explain one possible consequence of overtightening.

Final assembly tolerances and quality gates

A tolerance is the acceptable variation from the intended result. Its effect matters as well as its size: a small difference can create an unsafe sharp edge, rocking or damaging restraint in a critical location. Use the drawing, teacher guidance and functional checks rather than inventing a numerical limit. Before finishing, check safety and stability, then fit and function, then consistent appearance. Resolve loose parts, open joints and fitting faults at this hold point. A coating cannot repair the structure beneath it.

Before the next stage

Use a reliable reference, name the cause and recheck the result. Record an unresolved issue before work makes it harder to correct.

Recall • reason • record

Check understanding • apply it

Choose one answer for each source question. Then explain your reasoning in the applied response. These workbook tasks support practice; follow the teacher's current assessment instructions.

1. Across which direction does a solid timber top normally show the greatest seasonal movement?

- ☐ A Across the grain, as its moisture content changes
- ☐ B Along the grain only
- ☐ C Equally in every direction
- ☐ D Only through the thickness of the finish

2. One corner of the top sits high during a trial fit. What is the best first response?

- ☐ A Check for debris, proud joints or hardware, frame twist and top distortion before forcing it down
- ☐ B Use one fixing to pull the corner flat
- ☐ C Sand the entire top underside at random
- ☐ D Assume the floor is responsible

3. What is the strongest hold point before the top and hardware move to final finishing?

- ☐ A Teacher-approved checks confirm alignment, stability, safe hardware, operation and movement allowance
- ☐ B The top looks acceptable from one side
- ☐ C All fixings have been tightened with maximum force
- ☐ D No written evidence has been recorded

A classmate proposes pulling a high top corner down with one screw. Explain the problem with this proposal and describe a short diagnostic sequence before the pre-finish hold point.

Recall • reason • record

Make the diagnosis testable

A useful diagnosis separates an observation from a cause. The loose boards pictured below make their grain, edges and contact line easy to inspect. They do not show the approved tabletop construction, a measured flatness result or a fixing method.



Figure 14. Illustrative loose boards reused from Breadboard. Use the visible surfaces to practise observation; the image is not a construction detail for this table.

Worked example • one corner is high

Hypothetical observation: the trial-fitted top rocks on a stable frame. Checking finds a loose chip on one bearing surface. Removing that chip and repeating the same trial fit eliminates the rocking. The evidence supports this correction; it would not justify planing every rail or changing the fixings.

Observation	Evidence needed before correction
Top appears off-centre	Compare all approved overhangs from consistent references.
Corner remains high	Separate top, frame and interface causes on a reliable flat reference.
Top secure after fitting	Recheck contact, alignment and the intended movement allowance.

A different trial fit still rocks after debris is removed. Write a cause → check → approved action → retest sequence. Explain why the loose-board image cannot prove which correction the actual table needs.

Read • notice • apply

Read the surface before sanding

Inspect before sanding

Inspect the whole assembled table before choosing an abrasive. Use raking light across the top, legs, rails, apron and joints, changing your viewpoint so grain does not hide scratches. Gentle touch with clean fingertips can reveal ridges and rough areas. Classify the finding: a surface scratch, a moving joint and an incorrect profile need different responses. Record the location and likely cause. Stop for teacher advice when correction could alter the shape, reduce a component or affect a fitted joint; sanding is not a diagnosis.



Figure 15. Original teaching illustration reused from Folding Chair. Cross-grain scratches remain visible in low-angle light beside a prepared face; neither sample is a student result.

Abrasive grit, scratch pattern and grain direction

Each abrasive grade has a job. A lower grit number generally means coarser particles that remove deeper marks; later grades remove the scratches left by the previous stage. Follow the approved sequence and inspect before moving on. Fine paper may polish around a deep scratch while leaving it visible under finish. Work with the grain and use a suitable block on flat areas to spread pressure. Remove loose particles as directed between stages so they do not introduce new random scratches into prepared timber.

Sanding tapered legs, curves and edges without changing shape

Surface refinement must preserve the approved form. Support each component and distribute pressure with the directed block or backing. Work along a taper and compare matching legs from the same angle. Protect shoulders and crisp joint lines from uncontrolled rounding. Where a curve is specifically approved, use support that follows it without making flats or hollows; confirm any variation from the supplied straight-apron plan first. Check reflections and edge widths frequently. Do not keep sanding one scratch until the surrounding sound surface becomes a hollow.

The face looks smooth, but one deep cross-grain scratch remains. Explain why changing straight to finer paper may fail and how you would protect the approved shape.

Read • notice • apply

Correct, inspect and hand over

Defect repair and glue residue

Glue residue can block finish absorption and leave a pale patch, while a dent, tear-out or split has a different cause. Inspect each defect before choosing removal, blending or an approved repair. Do not fill an open structural joint to make it less visible. A repair must suit both timber and finish, and its visibility matters on the tabletop and front-facing surfaces. Trial the proposed treatment on matching scrap where directed. Remove residue fully without spreading it through excessive sanding or enlarging the damaged area.

Final surface inspection with raking light and touch

Final surface inspection follows a fixed route, including undersides, edges and joint lines. Remove loose dust first, then send light across the surface at a low angle. Change the light direction and your viewpoint to reveal scratches, ridges, glue patches and waves. Confirm gentle changes by touch with clean hands. Record a specific fault and location rather than writing 'sand more'. Use the least invasive approved correction, then repeat the same inspection. Stop if further work would reduce the component or change its profile.

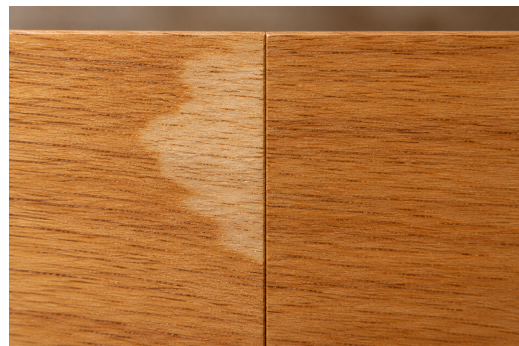


Figure 16. Illustrative joint detail reused from Mirror. The pale patch is a clue to investigate; its cause cannot be established from appearance alone.

Dust control, clean-up and pre-finish quality assurance

Fine timber dust affects health and finish quality. Control it at the source using the provided extraction and directed working methods; the specified respiratory and eye protection add personal protection. Do not blow dust into the air or across another person's work. Clean machines, benches and floors using workshop procedures. Remove dust from corners, joints and the underside of the top, then protect the table from active sanding nearby. The pre-finish hold point confirms sound construction, completed inspection, cleanliness and teacher approval to proceed.

A pale patch appears beside a joint on a trial finish. Explain one likely cause, one check and the boundary at which you should seek teacher advice.

Recall • reason • record

Check understanding • apply it

Choose one answer for each source question. Then explain your reasoning in the applied response. These workbook tasks support practice; follow the teacher’s current assessment instructions.

1. Why should dried glue be removed before normal finish sanding?

- ☐ A It can block finish absorption and appear as a pale patch
- ☐ B It makes the timber stronger and should be left
- ☐ C It automatically becomes invisible under clear finish
- ☐ D It makes the finish cure faster

2. Why should each grit remove the scratches from the previous grit?

- ☐ A Otherwise deep scratches may remain visible after finishing
- ☐ B To make the timber permanently softer
- ☐ C To reduce the number of quality checks
- ☐ D Because finish fills every scratch completely

3. Why are raking light and touch useful during final surface inspection?

- ☐ A They reveal scratches, glue, dents, ripples and sharp transitions that may be missed under normal viewing
- ☐ B They prove every joint is structurally sound without other checks
- ☐ C They replace dust control
- ☐ D They make the finish cure faster

Plan a pre-finish inspection route for your approved table. Explain how you would distinguish a surface defect from a structural fault and prevent new dust contamination after correction.

Recall • reason • record

Classify the fault before the repair



Figure 17. Illustrative surface samples reused from Desk Tidy. The comparison shows changing scratch patterns; no numbered grit sequence is encoded by the paper colours.

Surface preparation is a series of decisions, not a race through grit numbers. A persistent scratch needs its cause and depth checked; a hollow created by chasing it is a different fault. The appropriate response must preserve the approved shape and leave a surface the next stage can actually refine.

Worked example • polished but still scratched

Hypothetical result: the broad face reflects light evenly except for one deep line across the grain. A finer abrasive has made the surrounding area shinier without removing the line. Return to the teacher-directed correction decision, use suitable backing and check the whole surface often. Do not continue pressing on the line until a hollow forms.

Finding	Surface / structural / shape	First check or boundary
Open joint with movement		
Glue-like patch near a shoulder		
Rounded shoulder after sanding		

Complete the table. Then explain how you would verify one approved surface correction and prepare a clean handover for finishing.

Read • notice • apply

A finish is a controlled system

Follow the approved finish system

The teacher selects the finish system for the timber, intended use and workshop controls. Before opening it, read the exact label, supplied instructions and current Safety Data Sheet. Check preparation, application, handling, drying and curing requirements. A matching offcut provides a useful trial only when it receives the same preparation and finish system as the table. Compare colour, absorption and surface response. Organise the clean finishing area, access and approved quantity first. A similar-looking container is not evidence that another product is compatible or safe to substitute.



Figure 18. Illustrative test sample reused from Desk Tidy. Adjacent bare and coated areas reveal a change in appearance, without identifying an approved finish product.

Applying a timber finish evenly

An even finish depends on a prepared, clean surface and a controlled application route. Follow the selected product's method, working with the grain and maintaining the directed amount on the applicator. Plan access to the top, legs, rails, apron and undersides without leaning across wet surfaces. Check vertical faces and lower edges for runs, heavy build-up and missed areas from several angles. More product does not automatically improve protection. Handle and support the table only as directed so a successful coat is not marked during the next movement.

Drying, curing, handling and between-stage preparation

Drying and curing describe different stages. A coating can feel dry to touch while it is still developing hardness, adhesion and resistance. Protect it from dust, contact and unauthorised handling in the designated location. Do not stack objects on the top or wrap it while vulnerable. Follow the exact instructions for any between-stage preparation and recoating; appearance alone cannot establish readiness. The teacher confirms when the required stage has been reached. No universal waiting time in this workbook replaces the selected product's instructions and conditions.

Explain why a trial piece must match the table's preparation and why a touch-dry coat is not enough evidence that the table is ready for use.

Read • notice • apply

Control exposure and reduce waste

Chemical safety

Chemical controls must match the actual finish. Use the designated area, required ventilation and product-specific PPE; ordinary workshop gloves are not automatically chemically resistant. Avoid skin and eye contact, keep containers closed when not in use and control ignition sources as directed. Never mix products or transfer them into an unlabelled container. Report a spill immediately and follow the teacher's procedure. Place used application materials in the designated safe container because some residues create fire risk. Do not leave contaminated rags folded, piled or on a bench.

Using the label, SDS and hierarchy of controls

The label gives immediate product information; the current SDS provides fuller hazard, first-aid, exposure, storage and spill details. Read the relevant parts before work, with the teacher applying them to school procedures. Controls should reduce the hazard before relying on personal protection. A teacher-approved lower-risk system, designated area and effective extraction may provide stronger protection than PPE alone. Training, supervision and access limits also matter. During a spill or exposure, alert the teacher and follow the procedure rather than improvising from memory or a different product's sheet.



Figure 19. Illustrative finishing equipment at rest. The teacher-supplied product label, current SDS and workshop instructions determine the actual equipment and controls.

Sustainable practice and responsible waste handling

Sustainable finishing balances durability with resource use. Plan the approved quantity and application so spills, runs and unnecessary repeat coats are avoided. Keep suitable offcuts clean and dry for finish trials or later uses. Careful surface checks reduce wasteful rework in timber, abrasives and coating. Separate dust, clean offcuts, contaminated application materials and containers according to workshop directions; their disposal routes may differ. A finish can consume resources now while extending the table's service life. Explain that trade-off with evidence rather than claiming that all timber products are automatically sustainable.

Give one control that reduces exposure before PPE is relied on. Explain why ordinary workshop gloves and an old SDS are insufficient for choosing the finish procedure.

Recall • reason • record

Check understanding • apply it

Choose one answer for each source question. Then explain your reasoning in the applied response. These workbook tasks support practice; follow the teacher's current assessment instructions.

1. What should be checked before opening a finishing product?

- ☐ A The exact label, intended use, hazards, precautions and current SDS
- ☐ B Only the colour on the lid
- ☐ C Whether another student likes the smell
- ☐ D Whether the container can be poured into a drink bottle

2. Why is PPE placed near the bottom of the hierarchy of controls?

- ☐ A It depends on correct selection, fit and use and does not remove the hazard
- ☐ B It is never useful
- ☐ C It always costs more than elimination
- ☐ D It changes the product into a harmless substance

3. What is the main difference between drying and curing?

- ☐ A Drying is an early handling stage; curing is the longer development of hardness and resistance
- ☐ B They are exactly the same
- ☐ C Curing always occurs before application
- ☐ D Drying only applies to timber, not coatings

A classmate wants to use a similar-looking finish, wear general workshop gloves and pack the table as soon as it feels dry. Explain three decisions that must change before this plan is suitable.

Recall • reason • record

Read the product, plan the controls

This is a reading and planning exercise using the exact finish label and current SDS supplied by the teacher. If the documents are not available, write “Teacher to confirm” in the relevant field. Do not choose a substitute product or guess a control from a photograph. The completed worksheet does not itself authorise chemical use.

Worked example • separate a question from an instruction

“Which glove material is compatible with this product?” is a useful question to resolve through the current SDS and school procedure. “Any glove will do” skips that evidence. A note should identify the product and the source of the requirement, then record the teacher-confirmed procedure before work starts.

Information to locate	Evidence from supplied documents / teacher
Exact product and current SDS identity	
Ventilation and exposure-control requirements	
Product-specific PPE and glove suitability	
Handling, drying and curing requirements	
Spill reporting, storage and waste instructions	

Complete the reading record with source references or “Teacher to confirm”. Explain how one planned control reduces exposure and how one handling or waste decision avoids damage or unnecessary waste.

Read • notice • apply

Quality needs evidence

Systematic final quality checks

Compare the actual table with the approved drawing and agreed criteria in a consistent order. Start with safe handling and stability on a reliable flat surface, then check frame alignment, joint closure and matching leg tapers. Check the top's position, overhangs and secure fitting. Assess the apron against the approved form, including any specifically confirmed variation. Inspect finish and edges under good light. Test storage or moving hardware only if approved and present. Record the location, effect and remaining limitation of a fault instead of giving a general impression.



Figure 20. Illustrative record setting reused from Mirror. Tags can link individual parts to records; these blank tags provide no evidence of a student's actual work.

From problem to cause, correction and result

Problem solving connects a visible symptom to evidence, a likely cause, an approved action and a retested result. 'The top is crooked' needs a location and a reliable reference before it becomes useful. Check one possible cause at a time: a shifted top, distorted frame or incorrect reference could produce a similar appearance. Random sanding or tightening may create another fault. Record the actual decision and whether the result was resolved, improved or still limited. Do not invent a dramatic problem afterwards to make the folio sound impressive.

Collecting purposeful evidence

Collect evidence for a purpose. A whole-table photograph records overall form, while a close view can show a joint line or surface condition. Measurements and observations provide information a photograph cannot prove alone. Use good light and a safe, tidy setting so workmanship is visible honestly. Include planning, production checks and the final result where each item adds something useful. Avoid nearly identical images that repeat one claim. Every photograph and written statement must match your actual project; a workbook illustration cannot become evidence of your manufacture.

Choose one quality criterion for your table. State the evidence that would test it and one thing a photograph alone could not prove.

Read • notice • apply

Turn evidence into a judgement

Writing captions that explain what the evidence proves

A useful caption names the stage, explains the action or decision, points to evidence and states why it matters. ‘My table’ leaves the reader guessing. A dry-fit caption might identify measured diagonals and closed shoulders, then connect the result to frame alignment. Only claim what the photograph or attached record supports: a close view of one shoulder does not prove that every joint is sound. If a correction occurred, explain the before-and-after result. The caption should make the evidence interpretable without repeating an unrelated theory paragraph.

Evaluation is a judgement supported by evidence

Evaluation makes a judgement against a criterion. State the requirement, select evidence, judge how well it was met and explain a realistic improvement. A description such as ‘the finish is clear’ identifies appearance but does not assess quality. A stronger evaluation might use raking-light photographs to discuss evenness, a remaining scratch and its likely preparation cause. Include strengths as well as limitations, without exaggerating either. Link the next improvement to the cause, such as checking the previous scratch pattern before changing abrasive grade on a future project.



Figure 21. Illustrative documentation setup. Photograph your own project and attach a caption stating what the evidence supports; this generic practice piece is not submission evidence.

Selecting a concise portfolio evidence set

Select a concise evidence chain from brief and plan through decisions, manufacture, checks and evaluation. Keep a draft when it demonstrates development or correction; repeated copies add little. Choose the clearest evidence when several items prove the same point. Check that captions, measurements and photographs remain authentic and readable. The online folio stores work in the current browser, so download its ZIP backup before changing devices or clearing browser data. Use its twelve stages as an evidence checklist and follow current teacher instructions for the final submission.

Explain how you would choose between two similar photographs for the folio and what you would check before leaving the device.

Recall • reason • record

Check understanding • apply it

Choose one answer for each source question. Then explain your reasoning in the applied response. These workbook tasks support practice; follow the teacher’s current assessment instructions.

1. Which portfolio item provides the strongest manufacturing evidence?

- ☐ A One labelled photo showing the component, template comparison, quality result and date
- ☐ B Five identical photos with no captions
- ☐ C A decorative border around a blank page
- ☐ D A copied image of someone else’s table

2. What should a strong photograph caption include?

- ☐ A The stage, process or decision, evidence and outcome
- ☐ B Only “my table”
- ☐ C The student’s favourite colour
- ☐ D A copied paragraph unrelated to the image

3. Which improvement is most specific?

- ☐ A Be more careful next time
- ☐ B Mark matching components from one datum and compare the dry-fitted frame diagonals before glue-up
- ☐ C Try harder
- ☐ D Make it better

Write an evaluation of one genuine feature of your work so far: state the criterion, the evidence, your judgement and one realistic improvement. If work is not yet available, clearly label a hypothetical example.

Recall • reason • record

Edit a claim until the evidence fits

The records below are hypothetical editing examples, not observations from your table. A strong caption links a visible feature or attached measurement to a criterion. A strong evaluation then judges the result and proposes a cause-linked improvement. Keep these purposes distinct so the evidence does not make a larger claim than it supports.

Candidate record	What it can reasonably support
Whole table in clear light	Overall form and visible relationships.
Close view of one fitted shoulder	Closure and appearance at that specific joint.
Dated record of a stability check	The observed result under the recorded conditions.
Second nearly identical overall photograph	Little new evidence unless a relevant difference is visible.

Worked example • reduce an unsupported claim

Weak caption: “This photo proves every joint is perfect.” Better: “This close view shows the shoulder closed at the front rail after the dry fit. The separate frame checks record alignment before adhesive.” The revised caption says what this view shows and identifies where the additional evidence belongs.

Rewrite this hypothetical caption: “My table looks great, so it is completely accurate.” Choose two records from the table above and explain what each proves. Finish with one realistic evaluation statement and one improvement; label any imagined result as hypothetical.

Read • notice • apply

Present the real result

Final presentation and systematic inspection

Prepare the table for inspection without disguising faults. Clean it using the finish-compatible workshop method, then place it on a stable, level surface in useful light. Follow a fixed route through stability, frame, joints, top fitting, approved moving components, edges and finish. Compare the form with the approved drawing and any recorded variation. Clear presentation helps the teacher inspect the work; a temporary pad under a rocking leg or a camera angle hiding a fault weakens the evidence. Safety and function take priority over cosmetic extras.



Figure 22. Illustrative rail-to-post detail reused from Mirror. A close view can reveal one shoulder's closure; it cannot prove the whole table's stability or hidden joint strength.

Correct the cause, not only the symptom

A late fault still needs diagnosis. Repeat the original check on a reliable reference before removing material or tightening hardware. An uneven floor, for example, does not prove that a leg is too long. Protect adjacent finished surfaces and choose the least invasive approved action that addresses the confirmed cause. Change one thing at a time and repeat the same test afterwards. Record whether it is resolved, improved or still limited. Seek teacher advice before altering structure, joints or the approved shape, even when submission is close.

Care, maintenance and safe handling

Care should protect the table's function and finish. Use it on a stable floor, keep heat, moisture and unsuitable chemicals away, and avoid impacts or loads outside its intended use. Lift by supporting the frame rather than dragging from the top. Clean only by the method approved for the finish. Routine maintenance means observing condition and addressing small concerns appropriately; repair involves correcting damage with suitable knowledge and materials. Remove an unstable table from use until assessed. Good care and compatible repair can extend service life and reduce replacement waste.

A table rocks during the final presentation. Explain how you would confirm the cause and protect the finished work before deciding on a correction.

Read • notice • apply

Finish the project and the handover

Final submission as quality assurance

Submission is a final quality check on the evidence package. Follow current teacher instructions, verify name and class details, and open required exports to check readability and completeness. Select clear photographs of the actual table and its relevant details. Keep only the intended final files in the submission set, while preserving useful working backups separately. Download and check the folio backup so work is not left only in browser storage. Digital evidence explains decisions and results; it supports the practical project rather than replacing the workmanship shown by the table.

Reflection and transferable improvement

Reflection makes the next action clearer. Identify what happened, how the evidence shows it and which practice influenced the result. Choose a specific improvement such as comparing matching tapers before refinement or rehearsing clamp access before adhesive. ‘Be more careful’ gives no repeatable method. Explain why the proposed change would improve safety, accuracy, efficiency or quality on another timber project. A limitation can demonstrate strong learning when its cause and future response are honest. Record one effective practice to retain as well as one purposeful change.

Write one precise practice you would transfer to another timber project, then name one handover check for the workshop and one for your digital evidence.

Workshop reset and responsible handover

A responsible handover includes the shared workshop as well as the finished table. Clean and return tools, report damage or missing equipment, and sort useful offcuts and waste by the directed routes. Clean machines and benches using workshop procedures, leaving floors and access paths clear. Store or transport the table in the approved position with its finish and projecting parts protected. Verify that final exports and the folio backup open. Report unfinished issues to the teacher so the next class inherits an organised space and accurate information.

Before the next stage

Use a reliable reference, name the cause and recheck the result. Record an unresolved issue before work makes it harder to correct.

Recall • reason • record

Check understanding • apply it

Choose one answer for each source question. Then explain your reasoning in the applied response. These workbook tasks support practice; follow the teacher’s current assessment instructions.

1. Which final-work priority is strongest?

- ☐ A Safety and function before cosmetic extras
- ☐ B Decoration before checking loose hardware
- ☐ C Finish colour before checking stability and approved storage operation
- ☐ D Adding features after submission

2. What does “least invasive correction” mean?

- ☐ A Restore the requirement while changing or removing the least sound material
- ☐ B Remove as much timber as possible
- ☐ C Hide the fault with filler
- ☐ D Make several changes at once so the cause is unknown

3. What completes a professional workshop handover?

- ☐ A Tools returned, waste separated, chemicals secured, faults reported and access paths clear
- ☐ B Leaving clamps under tension on the bench
- ☐ C Hiding a damaged tool in a drawer
- ☐ D Mixing all waste in one container

Write a brief care and handover note for the table. Include safe lifting, finish-compatible cleaning, the response to later instability and one responsibility for the shared workshop.

Recall • reason • record

Leave a clear and useful handover

A handover should make unfinished issues visible. In the illustrated scenario, the bench may appear organised while the walkway remains obstructed. Checking only the most obvious work surface can miss another person’s risk. Apply the same thinking to records: a file name can look complete while its export is unreadable or missing evidence.



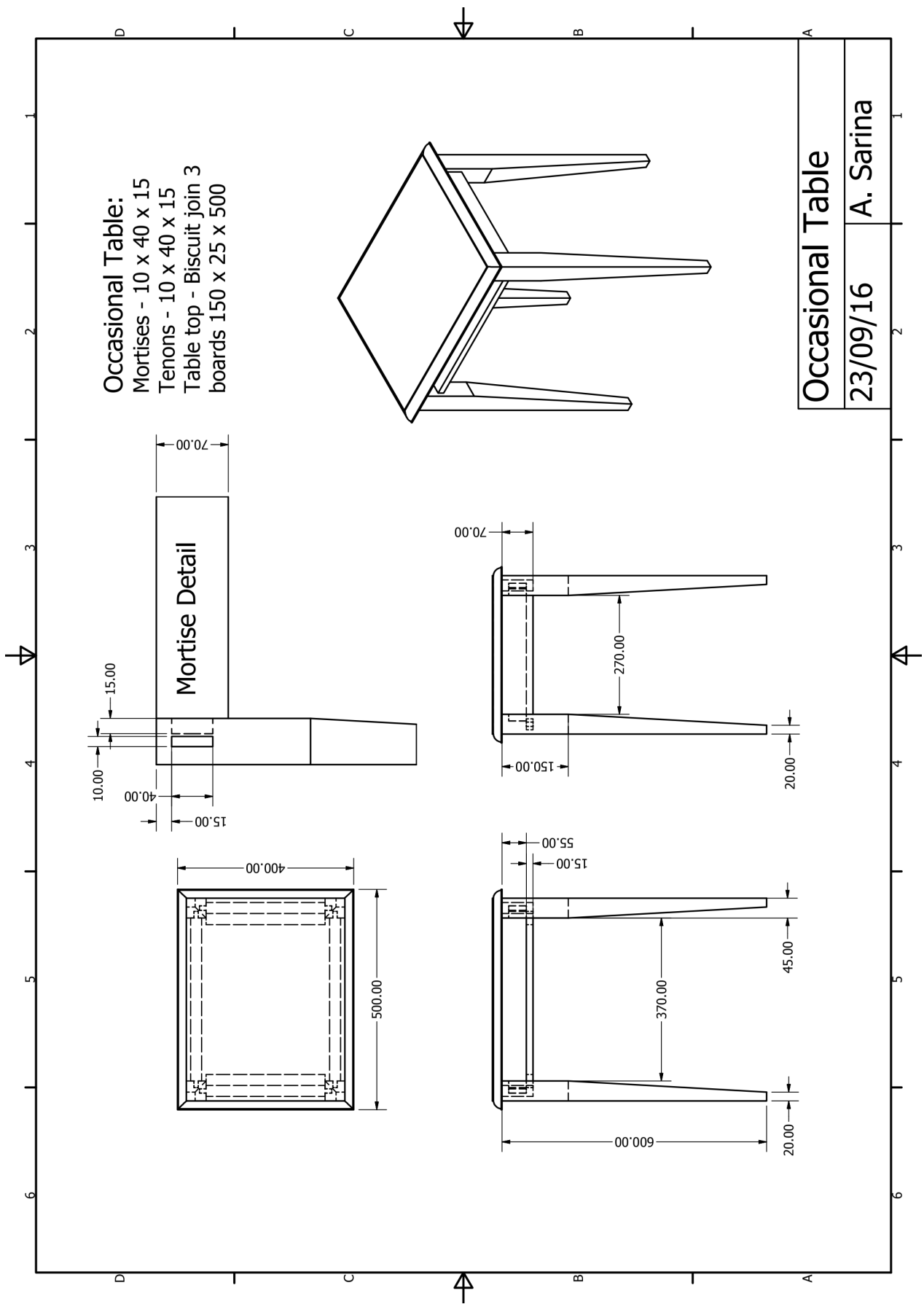
Figure 23. Illustrative workshop fault scene reused from Breadboard. The long timber obstructs the access route; this is a problem to identify, not a model of a safe handover.

Worked example • report the state accurately

Hypothetical handover note: “The project is in the directed storage position and the final export opens. One tool has been reported damaged and has not been silently returned to normal use.” A clear note tells the teacher what is ready and what still needs attention.

Area	Specific check or action
Illustrated access-route fault	
Tools and waste	
Project care and storage	
Digital evidence	

Complete the handover table. Then write one precise future practice that would prevent an issue shown here or encountered in your own project, explaining its benefit.



Original project drawing. Original source: Occasional Table, A. Sarina, 23/09/16. Complete sheet rotated and reduced from A3. Use written dimensions; do not scale. Confirm any variation with the teacher.

Recognise the tool and its job

A tool's shape helps you recognise it; the required result and current workshop SOP determine how it is used. These stationary references do not replace a demonstration.



Figure 24. Combination square / transfer and check reference relationships; keep the stock against the intended face.



Figure 25. Wooden mallet / controlled striking in an approved task. A tight joint is diagnosed, not hammered into place.



Figure 26. Eye protection / an additional control. Check condition and suitability; it does not replace guards or work holding.



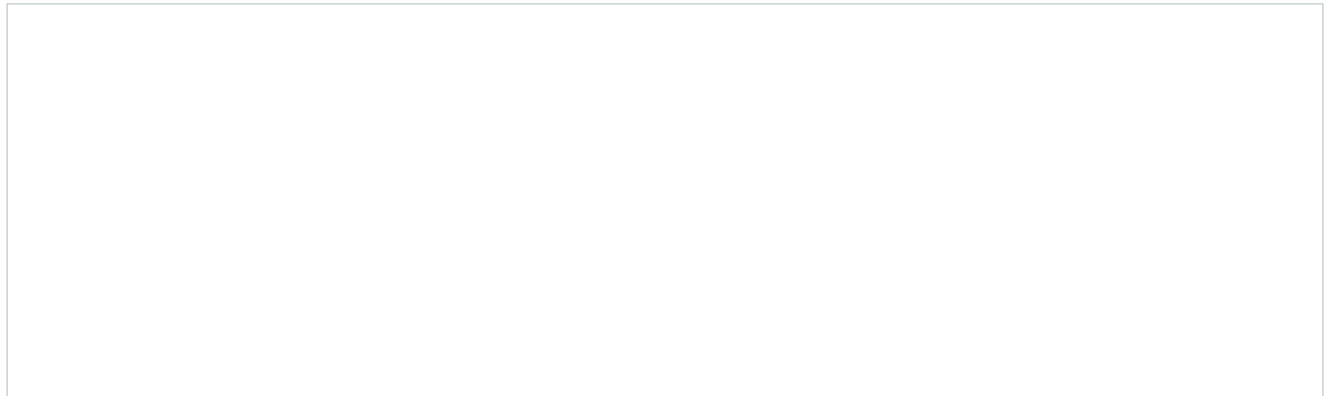
Figure 27. Biscuit joiner / recognisable registration fence and enclosed cutter housing. The original top note specifies biscuit joining.

Choose one pictured tool or item. Name its job in an approved task and one check required before use.

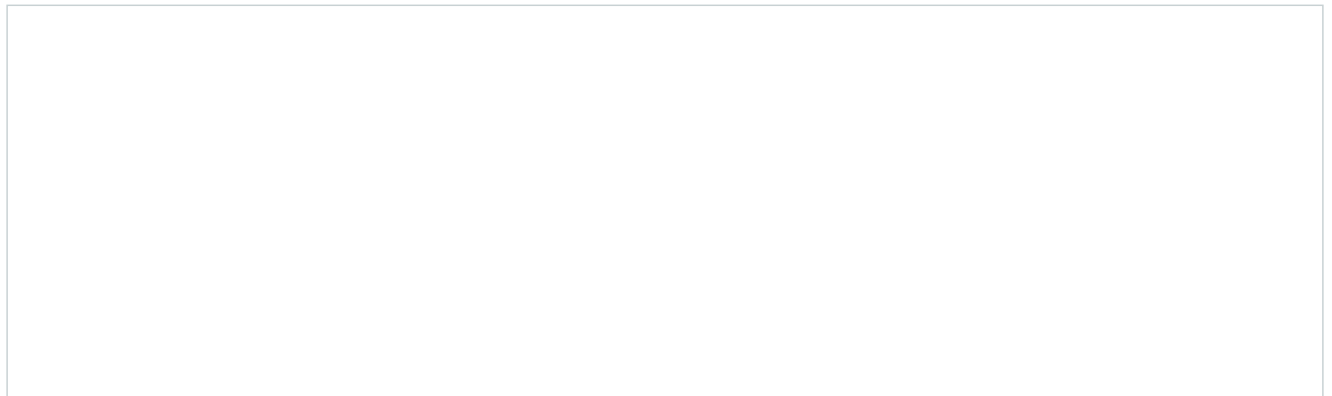
Define and explore your design

State the intended user, purpose and two success criteria for your table.

Concept A / sketch and annotate one choice that the teacher permits you to explore.



Concept B / show a meaningful alternative and name its main trade-off.



Which idea best meets your criteria, and what needs teacher confirmation before manufacture?

Record the parts and references

Use the original plan and your teacher-confirmed version. Continue a longer cutting list on an attached sheet; label that sheet with the same component names.

Complete a cutting list for the components you will make.

Component / quantity	Material / finished requirement	Reference and preparation note

Draw one component showing its datum faces, grain, identity, joint location and waste marks.

Explain one inspection or grain-placement decision that affected your cutting list.

Keep a useful making record

Record actual stages as they happen. Include timber preparation, joint trial, dry fit and assembly where relevant. Add another dated sheet if the full project needs more entries.

Record your process, result and next decision.

Date / stage	Task and tool/process	Check or problem found	Action / next step

Choose one entry. Identify the hazard, possible harm and controls used, including teacher/SOP direction.

Name the test-piece or dry-fit evidence that helped you decide to continue.

Capture evidence that proves something

Add or sketch your own checkpoint evidence. Label the feature, reference and stage it shows.

Write a caption: what was checked, what did you observe and what does that result show?

Record the relevant assembly evidence.

Checkpoint	Observation / evidence reference
Frame: shoulders, diagonals, twist	
Top: alignment, support and fixing	
Storage: approved version or not applicable	

What remains to be checked before the next stage?

Evaluate with evidence

Judge the finished table against your brief.

Criterion	Evidence / what happened	Judgement and next improvement
Function and stability		
Accuracy and workmanship		
Appearance and finish		
Material use and process		

Explain one real problem using problem → likely cause → approved action → result.

Which evidence best supports your strongest judgement? Explain why.

Care, reflect and hand over

Check your actual submission and workshop handover.

Evidence or handover item	Record / location / next action
Current teacher submission instructions	
Original plan and approved changes	
Process, WHS and quality evidence	
Finish/product information and care	
Evaluation, image captions and authenticity	
Project support, tool return and clean-up	

Write care advice suitable for the actual finish and table version. Name the source you used.

Name one skill you will transfer to a future project. Explain what you would do differently and why.

Course and source plan: stevenowell.github.io/bedside-table-guided-course/ · Current classroom instructions control assessment and submission. Illustrations explain concepts; your folio records your own work.